FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-25-23003

Issue Title : Potential for passenger seat disengagement due to improper installation of aft seat track fitting.

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2522-00	-8, -8200, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
10/04/2023	10/04/2023	06/08/2023
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
05/24/2024	01/10/2024	

Applicability

737MAX Model: 737-8, 737-8200, and 737-9

Description

Operator reported passenger seats improperly installed on a newly delivered 737 MAX airplane.

Background

During a service check, the operator reported multiple economy class passenger seats with the aft track fitting improperly installed in the seat track. The aft fitting shear plungers were not properly lowered and engaged in the seat track, seat track fitting locking clips were not engaged with the shear plunger fasteners, and locking clips were missing (see attachment photo).

Seats with improper installation of aft track fittings have the potential to disengage from the seat tracks under high loading, heavy turbulence, or emergency landing conditions that could result in passeger injury. The root cause was identified as a production quality escape that has been corrected with a Quality Assurance process change on the airplane production line beginning with Line Number (LN) 8583 and onward. This quality escape was not limited to any one specific seat supplier.

Status

Boeing has determined this incident to be safety related due to a potential for passenger injury resulting from a seat disengaging from the seat track under high loads. Therefore, Boeing has initiated Service Related Problem (SRP) 737MAX-SRP-25-0447.

Boeing is currently developing an inspection service bulletin, applicable to LN 7418 through LN 8582, to inspect the aft seat track fittings for proper installation.

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Interim Action

At the next maintenance opportunity, Boeing recommends a one-time visual inspection of proper aft seat track fitting installation for all passenger seats. In addition, Boeing recommends a one-time physical check of the security of the aft seat track fittings checking for evidence of looseness (play) and rattling. If found with excessive looseness and/or missing components, Boeing recommends to reinstall the aft seat track fitting per the applicable seat supplier Component Maintenance Manual (CMM) and/or per the applicable seat assembly installation Boeing Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM) tasks.

NOTE: Due to the variety of passenger seat assembly suppliers and seat assembly models, the appropriate CMM documentation may vary. For assistance with the aforementioned activities, operators may submit a Service Request (SR) to Boeing for additional guidance and advice.

Final Action

A Quality Assurance process change was implemented starting with airplane LN 8583, and subsequent, to witness the fastener installation and torque application operations. This ensures engineering drawings and document requirements are met for the seat track fitting installations.

For delivered airplanes (LN 7418 to LN 8582), Boeing will issue an inspection service bulletin for the affected 737-8/-9/-8200 airplanes to inspect aft seat track fittings for proper installation. If improper installation is found, the seats shall be reinstalled per service bulletin instructions.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: 11-Feb-2023 (Completed)
Solution Selected: May-2023 (Completed)
Change Committed: 29-Sep-2023 (Target)
Production Incorporation (LN 8583 and onward): 11-Feb-2023 (Completed)
Service Bulletin Available: May-2024 (Target)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Related Problem (SRP)	737MAX-SRP-25-0447	New	05/17/2023

Related Categories

- Manufacturing Quality Issues : Issues related to airplane or component manufacturing quality
- SRPs - Safety : Service Related Problems in work by Boeing that have an airplane or personal safety impact

Attachments:

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a) Seat Track fitting Photos

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